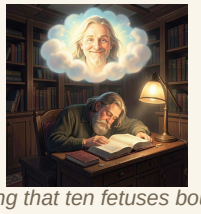
LAF YOMI

Bekhorot 56 · November 13, 2026

ON TODAY'S DAF

Maaser behemah — the animal tithe. A purchased or gifted animal is exempt, and the Gemara tests the verse 'so you shall do with your oxen and your sheep' against sin offerings, burnt offerings and the festival burnt offering to prove it means the tithe. R. Yochanan rules that ten fetuses bought in the womb do enter the pen to be tithed; R. Elazar defends him on the strength of a dream. The daf closes with the etnan bought back from a prostitute, and brothers who divide their inheritance and recombine — partners, exempt from the tithe but owing the kalbon.

MAASER BEHEMAH · THE DREAM THAT CERTIFIES THE SHIUR



1. R. Elazar needs to defend R. Yochanan's ruling that ten fetuses bought in the womb still enter the pen to be tithed. His opening credential: 'I saw R. Yochanan in a dream.'

“Elefant runs with it: seeing a sage's face brings siyata di-shmaya for learning — Rebbi was greater than all his colleagues because he saw R. Meir from behind, and had he seen his face he would have been greater still. Happy is one who sees Eliyahu's face in a dream. A dream, it turns out, is a study aid.”

— Rabbi Moshe Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 56a · R. Elazar's dream — חזאי בחלמא · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 14:18

MAASER BEHEMAH · THE BARAITA THAT NEVER WAS



2. Rav Shimon bar Yakir challenges R. Elazar with a baraita: a purchased animal under eight days old is still exempt — so the exemption must apply even before the moment of designation. R. Elazar's reply is one line: 'This is not a Mishnah.'

“Elefant stops the shiur to admire the confidence: 'Just because I never heard of a baraita, does that mean the baraita is incorrect? How could somebody be so confident?' The answer: a baraita must hook onto a verse in the Written Torah — and he was sure this one couldn't. Never having heard it was, itself, the proof.”

— Rabbi Moshe Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 56a · 'This is not a Mishnah' — זו אינה משנה · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 17:33

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ETNAN · THE PAYMENT BOUGHT BACK



3. The Gemara works out when an animal given as a prostitute's payment and then bought back still enters the pen to be tithed. Elefant detours to a real sheilah: a man had a beautiful Sefer Torah written, then had to sell it to marry off a child. Now, Baruch Hashem, he is better off — and buys it back.

“Does it count as commissioned, or merely bought? The responsum rules from our Gemara: buying it back makes it a purchase, so it does not count as if he had it written. The animal bought back from the prostitute decides the fate of a Sefer Torah.”

— Rabbi Moshe Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 56a · the payment bought back — איזה אתנן · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 22:17

PARTNERS · THE WHISKEY THAT WAS ELEVEN-TWELFTHS SOLD



4. The Gemara's rule: partners are exempt from the animal tithe, because the verse says 'it shall be yours' — yours, not jointly owned. Elefant brings the poskim's test case: twelve partners in a whiskey business. Eleven sell their chametz to a non-Jew before Pesach. One doesn't.

“Eleven-twelfths of the whiskey is fine, they rule — whiskey is only rabbinic chametz, so retroactive designation applies, and 'it shall not be seen to you' doesn't cover jointly-owned chametz anyway. The whole sugya, poured into a bottle — le-halakhah ve-lo le-maaseh, of course.”

— Rabbi Moshe Elefant

In the daf: Bekhorot 56b · brothers who divided and recombined — חלקו וחזרו ונשתתפו · Hear it in the shiur: Rabbi Moshe Elefant · 40:05